

DS2444A — Your Part: How To Fill It Out

A plain-language, question-by-question guide to the part of the disability application you complete yourself. Updated July 2026.

How to use this guide

This walks you through the DS2444A, the part of the disability application you fill out. Your doctor fills out the other part (DS2444B). We go question by question, in plain words, with an example of how to answer. This is a companion to the accessible fillable copy. The official form lives at dia.alberta.ca. If you get stuck, the Alberta Supports Contact Centre is 1-877-644-9992.

If you were moved to ADAP and want back on AISH — read this first

Most people using this form now are not brand-new applicants. You were moved to ADAP on July 2 and you are asking to be reassessed for AISH. That is a real and open path.

It has **no deadline**. The government's own guide says you can apply to return to AISH at any time.

The government has said it will cover the cost of **one** medical assessment for people moved to ADAP. It is not automatic — you have to ask. And ask in writing whether it is fully covered and whether you will ever have to repay it, because that part is not yet confirmed.

The route runs through this form plus a current medical report. The report is the whole game. You do not need your old assessment to do this.

The one rule that saves people the most trouble

Tell the truth and tell all of it. Leaving something out that is found later does far more damage than the thing itself. Many assets and some income do not count against you, so list them and let the rules do their job. When a box is too small for the truth, write “see attached” and add a page.

Gather these before you start

- Photo ID, your Social Insurance Number, and your Personal Health Number.
- The last 12 months of statements for every bank and investment account.
- Your 3 most recent pay stubs, if you work at all.
- Papers for any other income: CPP, CPP-D, EI, insurance, support payments.
- Papers for assets: vehicle, home, life insurance with a cash value, savings plans.

Your Situation (top of the form — read this first)

These questions can save you from filling out the whole application. Answer them truthfully before anything else.

Palliative or terminal illness?

If a medical professional has told you your illness is terminal, or you are in palliative care, check Yes. This is one of the groups that stays on AISH. Flag it clearly.

Living in, or approved and waiting for, a care facility or continuing care?

If yes, and a professional has assessed you as needing permanent placement, check Yes to both. Continuing care is also a group that stays on AISH.

“Stopped AISH or ADAP less than two years ago, condition unchanged”

If this is you, the form tells you to contact an Alberta Supports office instead of filling out the whole thing. That can be a faster door. Worth a phone call first.

If none of those apply, check None of the above and complete the full application.

Information About You (Q1–Q11)

Q1. Have you had AISH or ADAP in the last 24 months? If your file was moved to ADAP on July 2, 2026, check the box that says your file was transitioned to ADAP. This tells them you are a current client asking to be reassessed for AISH, not a brand-new applicant.

Q2. Waiting on an earlier AISH decision? Answer truthfully. If you already have an application in progress, say Yes so they do not treat this as a duplicate. There is no penalty for being in the queue, and reapplying does not cancel or reset anything you have already filed.

Q3. Are you receiving Income Support right now? Yes or No. If yes, you can skip the Income and Asset sections.

Q4–Q6. Residency and status. Q4: Alberta resident. Q5: immigrated or foreign national. Q6: your status — Canadian citizen, permanent resident, or sponsored immigrant. If sponsored, add the start and end dates and include your Record of Landing.

Q7. Your living situation. Check the one box that fits; if you live somewhere unusual, check the nearest box and add a note.

Q8–Q9. Spouse or partner. Check your marital status and, if you have a partner, whether they receive AISH, ADAP, or Income Support. “Partner” includes common-law, so answer for how you really live.

Q10. Dependent children. List each with birth date, whether they live with you, and if 18 or 19 whether still in high school.

Q11. Trustee or Power of Attorney. If someone is legally acting for you, put their details here. A family member only helping you fill this out is not a trustee — name them later as a contact person.

Employment History (Q12–Q21) — the section that matters most

This is where an application is quietly won or lost. The aim is not to prove you never work. It is to show the truth: that you cannot reliably sustain work. Willing but unable is a real and common answer. Doing a little, at great cost, is evidence of how hard work is for you — not proof that you are fine.

Q12. Did you use any employment services or supports? Yes or No. If yes, list what was recommended and what you tried. If no, explain plainly — for example: “My condition has prevented me from taking part in employment programming.”

Why a blank “no” needs an explanation

The government's own July 2026 Adjudication Guide lists, as a reason to place someone on ADAP rather than AISH: *“The applicant does not have proof of prior participation in employment services.”*

So if you have never used employment services, do not leave it blank. Say **why** — that your disability is the reason you never could. An unexplained blank can be read as capacity you do not have.

Q13. Are you willing to work if given the opportunity? This asks about willingness, not ability. Most people want to work, and answering truthfully is right. Whether you can *sustain* work is the real test, and that belongs in Q15 and in your doctor's report.

A caution about this question

We used to tell people that saying “yes, willing” could not hurt them. The government's own Adjudication Guide now makes us add a caution: it lists *“expressed willingness to work”* as a factor that can place someone on ADAP.

We will never tell you to lie. Answer as it is true for you. But do not stop there. If you are willing but unable, the word **unable** has to carry real weight in Q15 and in the medical report. Willingness alone, with a thin Q15, is the exact pattern that lands people on ADAP.

Say the truth: I would work if I could, and here is why I cannot.

Q14. What steps have you taken to find work compatible with your disability? Describe what you tried, and be truthful if the answer is very little because of your health.

Q15. Share how your disability affects your ability to work (marked optional — do not skip it). This box is labelled optional. Treat it as the most important thing on your part of the form. This is your one open space to describe, in your own words, why reliable work is not possible for you.

COPY / PASTE — EDIT EVERY BRACKET TO YOUR OWN TRUTH

My disability affects my ability to work in the following ways:

When my capacity depends on someone else: I can do tasks when a person is beside me directing me step by step, but on my own I cannot reliably start, organize, or finish what a job needs.

When your condition is unpredictable: My condition flares without warning. There are [days / weeks] I cannot leave home or function, and I cannot know in advance which days those will be. I cannot promise an employer I will show up.

When you have tried to work: I have tried by [taking pain medication to get through / working from home on good days]. The days I work leave me [unable to function for days after]. The work cost me more than it gave.

Everyday functioning: Day to day I struggle with [preparing meals / keeping appointments / managing medication / focus beyond [X] minutes]. This is my ordinary week, not a rare bad day.

Use only the lines that are true for you. Change every bracket. Write it in your own voice.

Q16. Are you currently employed? Yes or No, truthfully. A little work does not disqualify you — describe it truthfully.

Q17–Q21. Past and current jobs. List employers, role and duties (Q18), average hours per week (Q19), and the arrangement for seasonal or casual work (Q20). For **reason for leaving (Q21)**, if your health ended the job, check Medical condition. Do not soften it to “quit” if the real reason was your disability.

Education and Training (Q22–Q27)

These are quick. Check your highest level of school (Q22) and any training completed (Q23). Q24 asks what steps you took to find training that fits your disability — answer truthfully, even if your health has not allowed it. Q25–Q27 ask if you study now or plan to. Wanting to learn does not count against your disability claim.

Income (Q28–Q45)

Report every kind of income you and your partner get, with the average monthly amount, and attach the papers. A few worth naming: Q28 Employment (attach 3 recent pay stubs); Q32 CPP, Q33 OAS, Q34 insurance, Q35 pension (report all); Q43 Other income; Q44 Special payments in the last 12 months such as a gift, inheritance, sale, or compensation; Q45 whether you have applied for the DTC or CDB.

Q31 — the Canada Disability Benefit, and why reporting it stings

Report the CDB if you get it. But know going in what happens.

The regulation, Schedule 1 section 1(1)(e), **requires** the CDB to be counted as income. Alberta deducts it dollar for dollar. So the federal benefit meant to help you does not add to what you receive — it is subtracted from your provincial benefit.

This is not a choice a worker is making about your file. It is written into the regulation. Report it truthfully anyway; not reporting it is far worse than the deduction.

Assets (Q46–Q66) — exempt does not mean hidden

Fill in the value of anything you own. Many of these do not reduce your benefit, but you still have to list them. On the form, starred items are exempt: your LIRA (Q51), RDSP (Q52), and home / principal residence (Q62). A vehicle adapted for your disability (Q59) may also be exempt. List it, mark the value, and let the exemption apply. Hiding an exempt asset turns something harmless into a problem. Work down the list — bank accounts, cash, GICs, RRSP/RRIF, TFSA, stocks, trusts, life insurance cash value, vehicles, property, business — and attach documentation where it applies.

Declaration and Consents (the signatures)

Sign in every place that applies to you. A trustee, guardian, or attorney signs in their own line. A few notes: the AISH / ADAP consent lets them check your eligibility; the CRA consent lets them pull your tax information (normal); the CPP-D consent agrees to let CPP-D decide if you qualify, because AISH requires you to use all income available to you (standard, not a trick). If you want a trusted person or our campaign contact to talk to AISH about your file, name them in the contact box. Then check every page, make sure each signature and date is in place, and keep a full dated copy before you send it. Your copy is the start of your evidence file.

If it feels like a mountain

You do not have to climb it alone. Bring the question that is stuck to the group and we will take it apart one piece at a time. That is what we are here for.

*The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com — albertadisabilitysystembreakdown.netlify.app
General information, not legal or medical advice. Free to share, print, and post.*